SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

13 July 2022 · Shift 2

69 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 31 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. One of the baby elephants broke “off” from the herd and lost its way.

(A) No improvement required
(B) in
(C) down
(D) away

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Sturdy

(A) Delicate
(B) Dragging
(C) Tiny
(D) Drab

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. _____ is going to take the responsibility for this failure?

(A) Whom
(B) Who
(C) Which
(D) Whose

Q.4

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Pleasant

(A) Awful
(B) Delightful
(C) Faithful
(D) Sorrowful

Q.5

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who believes in fate

(A) Fatalist
(B) Optimist
(C) Mercenary
(D) Ascetic

Q.6

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To take with a grain of salt

(A) To take seriously
(B) To have total disbelief
(C) To believe with some scepticism
(D) To accept wholeheartedly

Q.7

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. We usually sleep in bedrooms with the door firmly shuted behind us.

(A) We usually sleep in
(B) bedrooms with the door
(C) No error
(D) firmly shuted

Q.8

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. You have to constant consider how your personal behaviour is going to impact everyone around you.

(A) You have to constant consider
(B) No error
(C) to impact everyone around you
(D) how your personal behaviour is going

Q.9

Select the option that will improve the bracketed part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.(Neither of the leading political parties have had much) success in the southern region.

(A) No improvement required
(B) Neither of the leading political parties has had much
(C) Neither of the leading political party has had much
(D) Neither of the leading political parties have had any

Q.10

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The collection and study of postage stamps

(A) Philately
(B) Ornithology
(C) Philosophy
(D) Philanthropy

Q.11

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Barricade
(B) Prosperity
(C) Bouket
(D) Dissatisfied

Q.12

Select the option that corrects the misspelt words in the given sentence. He maintins the unity and fredom of the suol.

(A) He maintains the unity and freedom of the soul.
(B) He maintains the unity and freedomm of the soul.
(C) He maintins the unitty and freedom of the soul.
(D) He maintins the unity and fredom of the soul.

Q.13

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Make a living

(A) To abuse someone
(B) To make excuses for everything
(C) To earn enough money for things you need
(D) To rely on corrupt money

Q.14

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who sells flowers

(A) Florist
(B) horticulturist
(C) Chauffeur
(D) Invigilator

Q.15

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Miniature

(A) Teeny
(B) Mammoth
(C) Average
(D) Miniscule

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Most employers _____ the use of mobile phones during office hours.

(A) prohibit
(B) submerge
(C) cultivate
(D) spirit

Q.17

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A disturbed state of mind caused by an illness.

(A) Delirium
(B) Discrepancy
(C) Dilemma
(D) Depreciation

Q.18

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Your infidelity have given me too much pain in life.

(A) given me too
(B) much pain in life
(C) No error
(D) Your infidelity have

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. His "wise choice" of men like Wolfe in Canada and Clive in India, and his vigorous measures in managing foreign affairs, made England respected in every part of the world.

(A) wisely chosen
(B) wisely choice
(C) No substitution required
(D) wise choose

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. These colours add a "vivacious" and fairy-like effect to my dress.

(A) repressed
(B) impassive
(C) sparky
(D) gloomy

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In Andhra Pradesh, low rainfall and increased (1) _____ on borewells have led to soil aridity, while (2) _____ snow and more rainfall has (3) _____ the desertification crisis in Himachal Pradesh. On the other (4) _____, in Rajasthan, canals, tube-well irrigation and shelterbelts have (5) _____ to an increase in the green cover.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) growth
(B) support
(C) addiction
(D) dependence

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In Andhra Pradesh, low rainfall and increased (1) _____ on borewells have led to soil aridity, while (2) _____ snow and more rainfall has (3) _____ the desertification crisis in Himachal Pradesh. On the other (4) _____, in Rajasthan, canals, tube-well irrigation and shelterbelts have (5) _____ to an increase in the green cover.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) few
(B) least
(C) less
(D) fewer

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In Andhra Pradesh, low rainfall and increased (1) _____ on borewells have led to soil aridity, while (2) _____ snow and more rainfall has (3) _____ the desertification crisis in Himachal Pradesh. On the other (4) _____, in Rajasthan, canals, tube-well irrigation and shelterbelts have (5) _____ to an increase in the green cover.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) deepen
(B) deepened
(C) deeper
(D) deep

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In Andhra Pradesh, low rainfall and increased (1) _____ on borewells have led to soil aridity, while (2) _____ snow and more rainfall has (3) _____ the desertification crisis in Himachal Pradesh. On the other (4) _____, in Rajasthan, canals, tube-well irrigation and shelterbelts have (5) _____ to an increase in the green cover.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) half
(B) hand
(C) sides
(D) case

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In Andhra Pradesh, low rainfall and increased (1) _____ on borewells have led to soil aridity, while (2) _____ snow and more rainfall has (3) _____ the desertification crisis in Himachal Pradesh. On the other (4) _____, in Rajasthan, canals, tube-well irrigation and shelterbelts have (5) _____ to an increase in the green cover.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) lead
(B) led
(C) leading
(D) leads

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the sixth number is related to the fifth number. 3856 : 8563 :: 4893 : ? :: 2873 : 8732

(A) 8934
(B) 3948
(C) 3984
(D) 8943

Q.2

Six people Ali, Parth, Roy, Minal, Sudhir and Zeeshan are sitting in a straight row facing North. Sudhir and Zeeshan are in the centre. Ali and Parth are at the corners. Roy is sitting to the immediate left of Ali. Who is sitting to the immediate right of Parth ?

(A) Sudhir
(B) Zeeshan
(C) Roy
(D) Minal

Q.3

In a certain code language, ‘Flames are bright’ is written as ‘@ # %’ and ‘Bright is sun flames’ is written as ‘* # 7 @’. Which one of the following is the possible code for ‘is’ in that code language?

(A) %
(B) @
(C) #
(D) *

Q.5

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. Some A are B. II. All C are B. Conclusions: I. Some B are A’s is a possibility. II. No C is A. III. All A are C.

(A) None of the conclusions follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) All the conclusions follow
(D) Only conclusion III follows

Q.8

In a certain code language, 'ri ti gi' is written as 'Usha playing cards', 'si ni gi' is written as 'Asha playing tennis' and 'ri si wi' is written as 'cards and tennis'. What is the code for the word 'tennis' in that language?

(A) ni
(B) ri
(C) wi
(D) si

Q.9

In a certain code language, 'PIZZA' is written as 'QJAAB' and 'BLACK' is written as ‘CMBDL’. How will 'BUZZY' be written in that language?

(A) CVAZZ
(B) CVAAZ
(C) CVABZ
(D) CTAAZ

Q.10

Which two signs need to be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 352 × 8 – 330 + 125 ÷ 4 = 214

(A) + and ×
(B) – and ÷
(C) + and ÷
(D) × and ÷

Q.12

A, B, C, D, E, F and G give a test. A scores more than B, C and D. G scores more than E and F. F scores more than A. Who scores the highest in the test?

(A) F
(B) A
(C) E
(D) G

Q.13

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. DGP : WTK :: MOS : ?

(A) NEH
(B) MLH
(C) NLT
(D) NLH

Q.14

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (2, 4, 36); (4, 6, 100)

(A) (8, 4, 1020)
(B) (12, 4, 230)
(C) (4, 4, 64)
(D) (14, 2, 75)

Q.15

Select the option that is related to the sixth number in the same way as the first number is related to the second number and the third number is related to the fourth number. 1503 : 3004 :: 871 : 1740 :: ? : 142

(A) 98
(B) 110
(C) 72
(D) 65

Q.17

Nine people Asha, Bishal, Carol, Dinky, Emily, Farah, Golu, Harsh, and Itika are watching a movie in a theatre sitting in a straight row facing North. Bishal is at one end of the row. Harsh is seated adjacent to both Farah and Golu. Carol is to the immediate right of Dinky and in the third place to the right of Emily. Asha is on the immediate left of Farah. Farah is in the third place to the left of Bishal. Who are at the ends of the row?

(A) Bishal and Dinky
(B) Harsh and Itika
(C) Carol and Emily
(D) Emily and Bishal

Q.18

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. A 1 : E 3 :: M 7 : Q 9 :: S 5 : ?

(A) W 7
(B) U 7
(C) W 5
(D) V 7

Q.19

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 6, 9, 7, 10, 8, 11, ?

(A) 12
(B) 9
(C) 11
(D) 10

Q.20

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: No atom is a molecule. No molecule is an element. Conclusions: I. It is possible for some atoms to be elements. II. Some elements are molecules.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows

Q.21

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and also '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 40 × 10 – 20 + 10 ÷ 2 = ?

(A) 4
(B) 8
(C) 6
(D) 2

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. ROM : SRT :: PNA : ?

(A) QQH
(B) QQI
(C) RQI
(D) QRH

Q.23

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. TX, ZD, FJ, LP, ?

(A) RU
(B) SV
(C) SU
(D) RV

Q.25

In a certain code language, 'POINT' is coded as '11', and 'GRANDST' is coded as '11'. How will 'HEMANT' be coded in that language?

(A) 8
(B) 4
(C) 9
(D) 7

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

In which state of India is the Iravatanesvara temple situated?

(A) Tamil Nadu
(B) West Bengal
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Telangana

Q.2

Which of the following cities existed in the Indus Valley Civilization?

(A) Harappa
(B) Sanchi
(C) Muziris
(D) Ayodhya

Q.3

What is the atomic number of Carbon as per Mendeleev's Periodic Table?

(A) 3
(B) 6
(C) 1
(D) 10

Q.4

The study of human populations including their size, composition and distribution across space and the process through which populations change is called _____.

(A) ethnography
(B) demography
(C) topography
(D) stenography

Q.5

Which of the following pairs of folk dance and the state associated with is INCORRECT?

(A) Giddha - Punjab
(B) Wancho - Arunachal Pradesh
(C) Ghumar - Bihar
(D) Nongkrem - Meghalaya

Q.6

Which of the following rivers rises in the Nepal Himalayas?

(A) Betwa
(B) Chenab
(C) Chambal
(D) Ghaghara

Q.7
How many different levels of courts are there in India?

(A) Two
(B) Four
(C) Five
(D) Three

Q.8
Aves are warm-blooded animals and have a _____ heart.

(A) four-chambered
(B) two-chambered
(C) five-chambered
(D) three-chambered

Q.9
Ustad Zakir Hussain is a famous Indian _____ player.

(A) Violin
(B) Guitar
(C) Sitar
(D) Table

Q.10
Joint sector industry is one of the classifications of industries on the basis of _____.

(A) source of raw material
(B) capital investment
(C) bulk and weight of raw material
(D) Ownership

Q.11
As per Census 2011, which of the following metro cities was the most populated in India?

(A) Kolkata
(B) Chennai
(C) Delhi
(D) Mumbai

Q.12
Which Indian state government launched Project Sadbhavana in February 2022?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Assam
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Gujarat

Q.13
In which year did Tipu Sultan die defending his capital Seringapatam?

(A) 1799
(B) 1802
(C) 1792
(D) 1794

Q.14
In the Union Budget of India 2022, what percentage of tax has been levied on transfer of digital assets (cryptocurrency)?

(A) 20 percentage
(B) 5 percentage
(C) 30 percentage
(D) 10 percentage

Q.15
Ajit Kumar Doval is the fifth and current _____ to the Prime Minister of India.

(A) Private Secretary
(B) Principal Secretary
(C) National Security Advisor
(D) Additional Secretary

Q.16
Which of the following teams won the ICC Women's World Cup 2021/22?

(A) Australia
(B) South Africa
(C) England
(D) India

Q.17
Padma Subrahmanyam is known for which classical dance form?

(A) Bharatanatyam
(B) Kathak
(C) Kuchipudi
(D) Mohiniyattam

Q.18
Which of the following does NOT fall under Non-Chordates?

(A) Annelida
(B) Porifera
(C) Vertebrata
(D) Mollusca

Q.19
Which of the following is one of the key features of the Indian Constitution?

(A) Autocratic government
(B) Dependent Judiciary
(C) Non-secular
(D) Federalism

Q.20
_____ was founded by the Dadoba Pandurang and his brother Atmaram Pandurang in 1863 when Keshub Chandra Sen visited Maharashtra, with an aim to make people believe in one God and worship only one God.

(A) Prarthana Samaj
(B) Satyashodhak Samaj
(C) Arya Samaj
(D) Brahmo Samaj

Q.21
Which planet in the solar system is considered as Earth's twin?

(A) Mercury
(B) Saturn
(C) Neptune
(D) Venus

Q.22
Who among the following Chola rulers built Nishumbhasudini Goddess temple in Thanjavur?

(A) Aditya I
(B) Vijayalaya
(C) Rajaraja I
(D) Arinjaya

Q.23
What is the name of Mahatma Gandhi's autobiography ?

(A) Justice for the Judge
(B) The Story of My Experiments with Truth
(C) The Bandit Queen of India
(D) My Music, My Life

Q.24
Who among the following is the first Indian Grandmaster to become Women's Chess World Rapid Champion?

(A) Tania Sachdev
(B) Koneru Humpy
(C) Harika Dronavalli
(D) Bhakti Kulkarni

Q.25
The International Sand Art festival is usually held in _____.

(A) Kerala
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Odisha

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.10 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**
Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) away

SSC's key gives 'away': to 'break away' from a group is to leave it, the usual phrase for an animal straying from its herd. 'Break off' is used mostly of a part coming loose or of ending something, though it is sometimes used of groups too.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Delicate

'Sturdy' means strong and solidly built; its opposite is 'delicate', easily broken. 'Drab' means dull and 'tiny' very small.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Who

The blank is the subject of 'is going to take' and stands for a person, so the subject pronoun 'who' is needed. 'Whom' is the object form and 'whose' shows possession.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Delightful

'Pleasant' means giving enjoyment: 'delightful'. 'Awful' and 'sorrowful' are nearly opposite, and 'faithful' means loyal.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Fatalist

A fatalist believes that events are fixed by fate and cannot be changed. An optimist expects things to turn out well, a mercenary fights for money and an ascetic gives up worldly pleasures.

Q.6 · Answer (C) To believe with some scepticism

To take something 'with a grain of salt' is to accept it with some doubt, not believing it completely.

Q.7 · Answer (D) firmly shuted

'Shut' has the same form in the past tense and past participle: 'with the door firmly shut behind us'. 'Shuted' is not a word.

Q.8 · Answer (A) You have to constant consider

A verb is described by an adverb, not an adjective: 'You have to constantly consider'.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Neither of the leading political parties has had much

'Neither' takes a singular verb, while the noun after 'of the' stays plural: 'Neither of the leading political parties has had much success'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Philately

Philately is the collecting and study of postage stamps. Ornithology is the study of birds, and philanthropy is giving to help others.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Bouket

The correct spelling is 'bouquet', a bunch of flowers.

Q.12 · Answer (A) He maintains the unity and freedom of the soul.

The sentence misspells 'maintains', 'freedom' and 'soul'. Only 'He maintains the unity and freedom of the soul.' corrects all three; the others keep a misspelling or add a new one ('freedomm', 'unitty').

Q.13 · Answer (C) To earn enough money for things you need

To 'make a living' is to earn enough money to pay for the things you need.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Florist

A florist sells flowers. A horticulturist grows plants, a chauffeur is paid to drive someone's car and an invigilator supervises candidates in an examination.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Mammoth

'Miniature' means very small; its opposite is 'mammoth', huge. 'Teeny' and 'miniscule' mean much the same as 'miniature'.

Q.16 · Answer (A) prohibit
Employers 'prohibit', that is forbid, the use of mobile phones during office hours. 'Submerge' means to put under water and 'cultivate' to grow or develop.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Delirium
Delirium is a disturbed state of mind, with confusion and restlessness, brought on by illness such as a high fever. A dilemma is a difficult choice and a discrepancy a lack of agreement between facts.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Your infidelity have
The subject 'infidelity' is singular, so it takes 'has': 'Your infidelity has given me too much pain in life.'

Q.19 · Answer (C) No substitution required
After the possessive 'his' a noun with its adjective is needed, so 'his wise choice of men' is already correct. 'Wisely chosen' and 'wise choose' put a verb form where the noun belongs, and 'wisely choice' an adverb before a noun.

Q.20 · Answer (C) sparky
'Vivacious' means lively and full of spirit, as does 'sparky'. 'Repressed', 'impassive' and 'gloomy' suggest the opposite.

Q.21 · Answer (D) dependence
'Dependence on' borewells, that is relying on them, has dried out the soil. 'Addiction' takes 'to', and 'growth' and 'support' do not fit the sense.

Q.22 · Answer (C) less
'Snow' is uncountable, so it takes 'less', which also matches 'more rainfall'; 'fewer' goes with plural nouns.

Q.23 · Answer (B) deepened
After 'has' the past participle is needed for the present perfect: 'has deepened the desertification crisis'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) hand
'On the other hand' introduces a contrast: Rajasthan's green cover has grown while the other two states face desertification.

Q.25 · Answer (B) led
After 'have' the past participle is needed: 'have led to an increase in the green cover'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (A) 8934
The first digit moves to the end: 3856 → 8563 and 2873 → 8732. So 4893 → 8934.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Minal
Facing north, Roy can be to Ali's immediate left only if Ali is at the right end, with Roy fifth from the left. Parth is then at the left end and Sudhir and Zeeshan take the third and fourth places, so Minal is second, to Parth's immediate right.

**Q.3 · Answer (D) *
'Flames' and 'bright' are in both sentences and share the codes @ and #, so 'are' is %. 'Is' and 'sun' take * and 7, so of the options only * can be the code for 'is'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Only conclusion I follows
'Some A are B' means some B are A, so conclusion I is true and certainly possible. Nothing fixes how A and C relate, so neither 'No C is A' nor 'All A are C' must follow.

Q.8 · Answer (D) si
'Tennis' is the only word in both the second and third sentences, and 'si' the only code in both, so 'tennis' is 'si'.

Q.9 · Answer (B) CVAAZ
Each letter moves one place forward, Z becoming A: PIZZA → QJAAB and BLACK → CMBDL. So BUZZY → CVAAZ.

Q.10 · Answer (D) × and ÷
Interchanging × and ÷: 352 ÷ 8 – 330 + 125 × 4 = 44 – 330 + 500 = 214.

Q.12 · Answer (D) G
F scores more than A, who scores more than B, C and D, and G scores more than F and E, so G scores the highest.

Q.13 · Answer (D) NLH
Each letter is replaced by its opposite in the alphabet (A↔Z, B↔Y and so on): D → W, G → T, P → K. So M → N, O → L, S → H: NLH.

Q.14 · Answer (C) (4, 4, 64)
The third number is the square of the sum of the first two: $(2 + 4)^2 = 36$ and $(4 + 6)^2 = 100$. Likewise $(4 + 4)^2 = 64$.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 72
The second number is twice the first minus 2: 1503 × 2 – 2 = 3004 and 871 × 2 – 2 = 1740. So ? × 2 – 2 = 142 gives 72.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Emily and Bishal
Farah is third to the left of Bishal, so Bishal is at the right end (ninth) and Farah sixth, with Asha fifth, Harsh seventh and Golu eighth. Carol, just right of Dinky, is third to the right of Emily, which fits only Emily first, Dinky third and Carol fourth, leaving Itika second. The ends are Emily and Bishal.

Q.18 · Answer (A) W 7
The letter moves 4 places forward and the number rises by 2: A 1 → E 3 and M 7 → Q 9. So S 5 → W 7.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 9
The steps alternate +3 and –2: 6, 9, 7, 10, 8, 11, then 11 – 2 = 9.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Only conclusion I follows
No statement links atoms and elements directly, so some atoms being elements is possible and I follows. 'No molecule is an element' rules out II.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 4
After interchanging the signs: 40 ÷ 10 + 20 – 10 × 2 = 4 + 20 – 20 = 4.

Q.22 · Answer (A) QQH
The letters move +1, +3 and +7: R → S, O → R, M → T. So P → Q, N → Q, A → H: QQH.

Q.23 · Answer (D) RV
Both letters move 6 places forward each time, wrapping round after Z: T, Z, F, L, R and X, D, J, P, V. The next term is RV.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 7
Add the letters' places in the alphabet, then the digits of the total: POINT = 16 + 15 + 9 + 14 + 20 = 74 → 7 + 4 = 11 and GRANDST = 7 + 18 + 1 + 14 + 4 + 19 + 20 = 83 → 8 + 3 = 11. HEMANT = 8 + 5 + 13 + 1 + 14 + 20 = 61 → 6 + 1 = 7.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Tamil Nadu
The Iravatanesvara temple, a Shiva temple of the Pallava period built in the reign of Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha), stands in Kanchipuram, Tamil Nadu.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Harappa
Harappa, on the Ravi in present-day Pakistan, was the first Indus Valley city to be excavated (1921) and gives the civilisation its other name, the Harappan civilisation. Sanchi is a later Buddhist site and Muziris an ancient port on the Kerala coast.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 6
Carbon's atomic number, the number of protons in its nucleus, is 6. Mendeleev himself ordered his table by atomic mass (about 12 for carbon); atomic numbers came later.

Q.4 · Answer (B) demography
Demography is the study of human populations: their size, make-up and distribution, and how they change through births, deaths and migration.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Ghumar - Bihar
Ghoomar (Ghumar) is a folk dance of Rajasthan, not Bihar. Giddha is from Punjab, the Wancho dance from Arunachal Pradesh and the Nongkrem dance from Meghalaya.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Ghaghara
NCERT names the Ghaghara, Gandak and Kosi as the Ganga tributaries that rise in the Nepal Himalaya. The Chenab rises in Himachal Pradesh, as the Chandra and the Bhaga, and the Betwa and Chambal in Madhya Pradesh.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Three
India has three levels of courts: the district (subordinate) courts, a High Court for each state or group of states, and the Supreme Court at the top.

Q.8 · Answer (A) four-chambered
Birds (class Aves) are warm-blooded and, like mammals, have a four-chambered heart that keeps oxygen-rich and oxygen-poor blood apart.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Table
SSC's key gives 'Table', the paper's spelling of 'tabla': Ustad Zakir Hussain (1951-2024), son of the tabla player Ustad Alla Rakha, was among the world's best-known tabla players.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Ownership
By ownership, industries are public sector, private sector, joint sector (owned jointly by the state and private parties) and cooperative sector.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Mumbai
Census 2011 counted Greater Mumbai as India's most populous city, with about 1.24 crore people (about 1.84 crore in its urban agglomeration), ahead of Delhi.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Assam
In February 2022 the Assam government launched Project Sadbhavana, a drive to dispose of long-pending files in the state secretariat at Dispur.

Q.13 · Answer (A) 1799
Tipu Sultan was killed on 4 May 1799 defending Seringapatam (Srirangapatna) against the British in the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 30 percentage
The Union Budget 2022-23, presented on 1 February 2022, taxed income from the transfer of virtual digital assets such as cryptocurrency at 30%, with 1% TDS on such transfers.

Q.15 · Answer (C) National Security Advisor
Ajit Kumar Doval became India's fifth National Security Advisor in May 2014, after Brajesh Mishra, J N Dixit, M K Narayanan and Shivshankar Menon, and held the post when the exam was held (July 2022).

Q.16 · Answer (A) Australia
Australia won the 2022 ICC Women's World Cup in New Zealand, beating England in the final at Christchurch on 3 April 2022.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Bharatanatyam
Padma Subrahmanyam is a Bharatanatyam dancer, choreographer and scholar of the Natya Shastra.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Vertebrata
Vertebrates are a subphylum of the Chordata. Annelida, Porifera and Mollusca are non-chordate phyla, animals without a notochord.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Federalism
The Constitution divides powers between the Union and the states, which makes federalism one of its key features. It also sets up an independent judiciary and a secular, democratic state, the opposite of the other options.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Prarthana Samaj
The description fits the Prarthana Samaj, founded in Bombay by Atmaram Pandurang after Keshub Chandra Sen's visit to promote the worship of one God; the year usually given is 1867, not the 1863 in the question. Satyashodhak Samaj was founded by Jyotiba Phule, Arya Samaj by Dayanand Saraswati and Brahmo Samaj by Raja Ram Mohan Roy.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Venus
Venus is called Earth's twin because it is close to Earth in size and density, and it is the planet that comes nearest to Earth.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Vijayalaya
Vijayalaya, founder of the Chola line of Thanjavur, took the Kaveri delta from the Muttaraiyar in the middle of the ninth century, built the town of Thanjavur and a temple there for the goddess Nishumbhasudini.

Q.23 · Answer (B) The Story of My Experiments with Truth
Gandhi's autobiography is 'The Story of My Experiments with Truth'. 'Justice for the Judge' is Ranjan Gogoi's, 'The Bandit Queen of India' Phoolan Devi's and 'My Music, My Life' Ravi Shankar's.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Koneru Humpy
Koneru Humpy won the Women's World Rapid Chess Championship in Moscow in December 2019, the first Indian to do so.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Odisha
The International Sand Art Festival is held each December on Chandrabhaga beach near Konark, Odisha, alongside the Konark Festival.

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